MONMOUTHSHIRE HISTORIC GAZETTEERS & STREET ARCHIVES

Newport Street Directories (1878–1971)

Statistical Analysis of Urban Expansion, Industrial Transition, and Social Topography

ARCHIVE OVERVIEW & SCOPE

This historical report analyzes **225,653 individual resident and commercial records** extracted from 21 directory volumes spanning from 1878 to 1971 across **1,309 canonical thoroughfares** in the County Borough of Newport. By tracing street density, occupational entries, multi-generational household continuity, and demographic changes, the dataset provides a quantitative window into the transformation of South Wales' premier coal port and industrial manufacturing center.

1. URBAN GROWTH & SURVEY SCALE (1878–1971)

Over the 93-year survey window, the network of surveyed streets expanded nearly seven-fold, capturing the annexation of suburban districts such as Maindee (1876/1889), the Edwardian expansion into St. Julians and Allt-yr-yn, the inter-war housing estates of Western Avenue and Gaer, and the post-war corporate borough estates of Bettws and Ringland.

VOLUME YEAR	TOTAL LISTINGS	ACTIVE STREETS	WITH STATED TRADE	FEMALE HEADS	FEMALE HEAD %	HISTORICAL ERA
1878	4,100	129	3,064 (74.7%)	427	10.4%	Victorian Port & Alexandra Dock opening
1882	6,375	186	1,378 (21.6%)	314	4.9%	Early borough street expansions
1886	7,572	286	4,761 (62.9%)	420	5.5%	Incorporation of Maindee Local Board
1893	8,168	229	4,901 (60.0%)	708	8.7%	Late Victorian commercial consolidation
1898	9,316	250	5,320 (57.1%)	956	10.3%	Pillgwenlly & Crindau industrial boom
1900	12,409	286	7,674 (61.8%)	1,288	10.4%	Turn of century municipal growth
1903	13,103	460	8,040 (61.4%)	1,262	9.6%	Edwardian thoroughfare survey expansion
1913	13,511	375	7,595 (56.2%)	1,298	9.6%	Pre-WWI commercial height
1920	14,701	383	8,136 (55.3%)	1,760	**12.0%**	Post-WWI demobilization & widowhood surge
1927	16,042	393	9,386 (58.5%)	1,993	12.4%	Inter-war suburban housing estates
1936	24,742	506	15,026 (60.7%)	3,110	12.6%	Orb Works & Lysaght peak steel production
1971	36,550	**882**	2,611 (7.1%)	3,448	9.4%	Post-war borough expansion (Bettws,

VOLUME YEAR	TOTAL LISTINGS	ACTIVE STREETS	WITH STATED TRADE	FEMALE HEADS	FEMALE HEAD %	HISTORICAL ERA
						Ringland)

2. THE THREE INDUSTRIAL EPOCHS OF NEWPORT

Occupational data recorded in the directories illustrates the three successive economic backbones that powered the town:

HISTORICAL EPOCH	LEADING TRADES & OCCUPATIONS	KEY EMPLOYERS & GEOGRAPHY	HISTORICAL TRAJECTORY
I. The Victorian Port Boom *(1878–1900)*	**Mariners** **Coal Trimmers** **Riggers** **Shipwrights** **Hobblers**	Alexandra (North) Dock, Town Dock, River Usk Wharves, Pillgwenlly.	Maritime trades outnumbered railwaymen nearly 3 to 1 in 1878 (216 vs 79). Coal exporting drove the town's early explosive wealth.
II. The GWR Railway Era *(1900–1920)*	**Engine Drivers** **Signalmen** **Guards** **Platelayers**	Great Western Railway, High Street Station, East Usk Junction, Crindau Yards.	In **1903**, railway listings (459) overtook maritime listings (435) for the first time, establishing Newport as the primary rail marshaling center.
III. The Heavy Steel Era *(1920–1936)*	**Sheet Rollers** **Puddlers** **Furnacemen** **Boilermakers**	John Lysaght's Orb Ironworks, Whitehead Iron & Steel, Dos Works.	Between 1920 and 1936, metal and steel listings more than doubled (from 923 to 2,202 listings), becoming the single largest employer in the borough.

3. MICRO-ENCLAVES: OCCUPATIONAL CLUSTERING BY STREET

Working families clustered tightly around their places of work. The data reveals strict spatial divides across different quarters of Newport:

⚓ The Maritime Quarter

Pillgwenlly & Docks

- **Jeddo Street**: 118 maritime listings
- **Marion Street**: 104 maritime listings
- **Lime Street**: 101 maritime listings
- **Commercial Street**: 99 maritime listings
- **Price Street**: 87 maritime listings

🚂 The Railway Enclave

Crindau, Maindee & Station

- **Lewis Street**: 95 railway listings
- **Capel Crescent**: 94 railway listings
- **Durham Road**: 70 railway listings
- **Capel Street**: 58 railway listings
- **Godfrey Road**: 48 railway listings

🏭 The Steelworker Belt

Corporation Road & East Bank

- **Dewstow Street**: 119 metal listings
- **Magor Street**: 105 metal listings
- **Downing Street**: 93 metal listings
- **Corporation Road**: 89 metal listings
- **Oakley Street**: 83 metal listings

4. MULTI-DECADE ADDRESS LONGEVITY (UP TO 89 YEARS AT THE SAME DOOR)

By linking family surnames with identical house numbers across consecutive directory volumes, we uncover remarkable multi-generational roots in Victorian and Edwardian terraces:

FAMILY SURNAME	STREET ADDRESS	TOTAL SPAN	DIRECTORY EDITIONS PRESENT
Williams	No. 5 Morgan Street	**89 years**	1882, 1886, 1893, 1898, 1899, 1902, 1903, 1971
Jones	No. 7 Caerau Road	**89 years**	1882, 1925, 1927, 1936, 1971
Edwards	No. 9 Blewitt Street	**81 years**	1890, 1893, 1900, 1902, 1920, 1925, 1927, 1936, 1971 (9 volumes)
Stallard	No. 21 Rose Street	**78 years**	1893, 1898, 1899, 1903, 1936, 1971 (6 volumes)
Brimfield	No. 7 Devon Place	**73 years**	**11 consecutive volumes** (1898, 1899, 1902, 1903, 1910, 1913, 1920, 1925, 1927, 1936, 1971)
Rawlings	No. 18 Bolton Road	**73 years**	1898, 1900, 1902, 1903, 1910, 1925, 1936, 1971 (8 volumes)
Merrick	No. 19 Rudry Street	**73 years**	1898, 1899, 1902, 1903, 1910, 1925, 1936, 1971 (8 volumes)
Tudball	No. 5 Graham Street	**73 years**	1898, 1903, 1913, 1920, 1925, 1936, 1971 (7 volumes)
Bailey	No. 68 Jeddo Street	**72 years**	1899, 1900, 1902, 1903, 1910, 1913, 1925, 1936, 1971 (9 volumes)
Sheppard	No. 23 Clyffard Crescent	**73 years**	1898, 1903, 1913, 1925, 1936, 1971 (6 volumes)

5. SOCIAL TRENDS, DEMOGRAPHICS & VANISHED TRADES

A. Female Heads of Household & The World War I Impact

In late Victorian volumes (1882–1886), female listings averaged between 4.9% and 5.5%, primarily identifying propertied widows and gentlewomen. In the **1920 directory**, immediately following the First World War, the

proportion of female-headed households leaped to **12.0%** (1,760 homes), remaining above 12.5% through 1936.

Among women listed with independent commercial enterprises, the most common occupations were: **Grocers & Shopkeepers** (276 listings), **Dressmakers** (101 listings), **Bakers & Confectioners** (58 listings), **Milliners** (34 listings), and **Laundresses** (33 listings).

B. Welsh Patronymic Surnames

Nearly **10% of the entire historical directory population** shared just five traditional Welsh patronymic surnames:

SURNAME	TOTAL HISTORICAL LISTINGS	% OF ENTIRE ARCHIVE
Jones	4,584	2.12%
Williams	4,010	1.86%
Davies	3,386	1.57%
Thomas	3,012	1.40%
Evans	2,182	1.01%

C. Vanished Victorian Heritage Trades

The directory archive captures historical trades that have since vanished from town life: **Blacksmiths** (454), **Saddlers & Harness Makers** (155), **Wheelwrights** (91), **Coachmen & Ostlers** (164), **Coopers** (43), **Lamplighters** (30), **Ship Chandlers** (11), **Herbalists** (9), and **Chimney Sweeps** (7).

Compiled from the *Newport Street Directory Project* archive

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